Zero Trust at ACME started as a response to a shifting security landscape, but it ultimately transformed much more than the company's defense strategy. By focusing on authorization and policy, ACME built an architecture that enhanced security while also boosting alignment, governance, agility, and resilience across the organization. Zero Trust became more than a security initiative to finish; it created an architectural perspective that allowed ACME to operate more reliably and transparently. The result was a system that benefited everyone, not just the security team.

15.8 Summary

- Zero Trust reframes enterprise security by emphasizing authorization over network boundaries.
- The lack of a meaningful perimeter makes location an unreliable trust indicator.
- Continuous, contextual evaluation of every access request is essential for a zero-trust security framework.
- Policy-based access control provides the decision layer necessary to enforce Zero Trust consistently.
- Authorization improves when identity, device posture, and contextual signals are accurate, up-to-date, and properly managed.
- Foundational policies specify enterprise-wide requirements such as authentication strength and device security.
- Shared operational policies modify access decisions based on operational or environmental factors.
- Application policies define rules and business logic for specific resources within each system.
- A policy engine can combine policies from different policy stores and evaluate them together in one decision.
- Forbid-overrides-permit semantics ensure consistent enforcement of foundational requirements across systems.
- Consistent authorization improves both security and productivity by ensuring reliable access.